

Killer rigs

Building a rig? Don't know what components to include? Fret not, we'll sort you out.

Recommended buys

This is Digit pick of the best products to buy across several categories, updated every month.

Also, with systems that incorporate multiple lights, you have the option to group a set of lights together and program it to your needs. There is also the added comfort of not having to check if all lights are turned off when you're leaving home in a rush, or in a particular area of the home when it is not required. The bottom line is that the customization possibilities are incredible.

• Energy saving:

Smart lights can also help you conserve energy, and save on electricity bills. For instance, the ability to dim a light to suit requirements is hard to do with traditional lighting. Also, with motion sensors at work, the light can automatically adjust or turn itself on or off when needed. Then, there's the option to combine smart lighting with LED-based lights. Since the latter uses lower energy, it will cut power bills. Yet another way to save electricity is to coordinate smart lighting in your home with smart blinds and window shades to enable maximum utilization of natural light.

• Setting profiles or scenes:

One of the coolest features of smart lights is the ability to configure the lighting to match the task and mood. For instance, if you are reading you can have a setting that not only adjusts the intensity of the light, but also the light colour. For a kitchen or bathroom, you could set a 'morning' profile that gradually turns on lights and increases the brightness. A custom profile like 'Vacation' can be used to make selected lights go on and off in a pre-determined fashion to simulate an occupied home—and deter burglars.

• Colours:

Thanks to colour-adjustable lights, a new innovation, it is now possible to illuminate a room in different shades and hues. So you could have a soft blue light to aid TV watching, or a bright white light for the kitchen from the same bulb.

The Future of Smart Lighting

Perhaps the most crucial change that smart lights have ushered in is the fact that lighting can now become an integral

WHAT'S AVAILABLE

Philips Hue

When it comes to creating a special mood in a room, Philips Hue is something of a specialist. Using its wireless system, not only can you turn the LED bulbs on or off but you can also choose the level of brightness as well as the colour.

Also, the product gives you the option to recreate colours based on an image—say a sunrise image. You can program the light to switch on or off at a particular time, and even has a party mode that flashes the light in time with music.

The fact that Philips Hue is compatible with IFTTT means that you get plenty of other modes of control like making the lights flash a particular colour when you receive a Facebook notification. IFTTT is an abbreviation for "If This Then That". It is a web-based service that allows users to create chains of simple conditional statements, called "recipes", which are triggered based on changes to other web services such as Gmail, Facebook, Instagram, and Pinterest.)

The starter pack for Philips Hue comes with three light bulbs, and a wireless base. Using the latter, you can manage up to 50 bulbs. A single bulb from the Hue family will cost you Rs. 2,699. Available at eBay.in

LIFX WiFi LED Bulb

This LED bulb lets change your lighting colour to match your mood, and functions using your existing WiFi. It can be used in conjunction with your smart phone, and the integrated music effects can pulsate the lighting in tandem with the music. The bulb is IFTTT compatible, and claimed to provide up to 22 years of illumination.

Price: ₹8,450.00. Available at fabtobalab.com

IFITech Smart Bulb

This is a LED Bulb with a built in motion and

daylight sensor. This bulb will automatically turn on upon sensing motion during the dark, and turn off in 60 seconds if no motion detected. Useful for washrooms, staircases and utility areas. The product claims a lifetime of 30,000 hours.

Price: ₹1,250. Available at amazon.in

IOTA Lite LED Smart bulb

Produced by the Indian technology firm, Cube 26, this 500 lumens dimmable model incorporates Bluetooth v4.0. Offering up to 16 million variations in colours, the product has such cool features as blinking lights for call alerts, music sync, modes for various settings and more.

Price: ₹1,499. Available at flipkart.com

3a Part 5 W LED EMIT Bluetooth Smart Bulb

3a's Bluetooth v4.0 enabled 500 lumens smart bulb comes with a purported lifetime of 25,000 hours. The product incorporates features such as colour-setting according to different moods, alarm function, remote control of brightness and automatic on/off.

Price: ₹2,399. Available at flipkart.com

Xiaomi Yeelight Smart LED

The Xiaomi Yeelight Smart LED comes with a Mobile app control using which you can manage up to ten lights via Bluetooth. Features include App timer switch, Music Rainbow- which is essentially a party feature, complete with throbbing lights, and also varying colours.

Price: ₹2,799. Available at eBay.in

Disclaimer: The specifications/price for the products mentioned may vary based on vendor/model. Images shown are representative only.

part of the design of the home, rather than a peripheral unit. You can use lighting to influence the character and utility of the home, and can change it at whim. Ease of use, better control, and the ability to leverage colour are some of the most significant changes that have occurred to make this possible—and we are likely to see many more useful features and capabilities being added like the ability to selectively focus a light or change the beam pattern.

As more and more household objects become Internet-enabled, smart lighting will gain the ability to interact with other objects in the home, enabling them make smart decisions by working in concert in a highly optimal way. Smart lighting also holds out the potential for customized and artistic lighting to be deployed widely in homes—and changed quickly to suit the situation and need. Your future home will look brightly different! 